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Organisation Overview

Yuppiechef | Online Retailer of Kitchen & Homeware Products

Name: Yuppiechef

Brief History

Yuppiechef was first founded in 2006 by the founders Andrew Smith & Shane Dryden as a part time side hustle from a lounge in Plumstead, Cape Town with 32 products on display and the goal to provide a much wider range of kitchen items to customers. The company has since grown into South Africa's number 1 kitchen and homeware retailer and in April 2021 was sold for R470m (approx) by the company founders to the Mr Price Group. They currently employ 467 staff and Yuppiechef is a leading retailer of food, gifts & homeware.

They offer 25 brick-and-mortar stores and more than 12,000 products that include cookware, home gadgets, appliances, gifts and various homeware items. It's also renowned for its handwritten notes, fridge magnet in every box and striving to make home and cooking an easier experience.

Mission Statement

Our mission is to provide South Africa with world-class kitchenware and homeware, to inspire better home living through inspiring products, an innovative approach and remarkable service. Mission Statement Our mission is to provide South Africa with world-class kitchenware and homeware, to inspire better home living through inspiring products, an innovative approach and remarkable service.

Website aims and objectives

Particular Aims

- To grow online revenue: To increase online revenue by 15% through a better user experience and an easy checkout process.
- To raise brand awareness: To have Yuppiechef regarded as the primary store for quality kitchen and home ware by cementing the brand story and values.
- To enhance the mobile experience: To create an easy to use mobile experience while paving the way for the upcoming mobile app.
- To facilitate product discovery: To assist customers in navigating over 12,000 products through simplified searching and filtering.
- To increase sales for gift range: To promote the gifting range and leverage increasing popularity of a high-quality gift.

Strengths:

- Extensive catalog of high quality products with well-developed descriptive data.
- Strong online and brick and mortar branding with recognized awareness.
- Stellar reviews and high levels of customer testimonials.
- Highly fluid navigation.
- Intuitive search
- Excellent retail customer experience across online channels

Weaknesses:

- Mobile user journey was not always as smooth or quick as could be desired
- Personalization options are fairly scarce (i.e. Product suggestions)
- The whole checkout process could be made quicker
- Gifting section not prominent or simple enough to find and use
- Pages with a lot of text need improved visual hierarchy

Things I'd enhance:

- Enhance mobile optimization of the website for better and speedier loading as well as mobile-friendly navigations
- Enhance personalized recommendations from previous browsing activity and purchase history
- Make the checkout process as efficient as possible with guest checkout and additional forms of payment
- Develop a specific and aesthetically pleasing section for gifting with personalized collections
- Enhance the visual hierarchy of each of the pages of the website in order to improve the way visitors read and interact with the content.

Proposed Website Features and Functionality

Essential Features:

Page	**Functionality**
Homepage	Hero banner showcasing seasonal collections, featured products, call to action buttons, navigation menu, promotional banners.
Shop Page	Product categories, filtering by brand, price and rating, search bar, product sorting options.
Product Detail Page	High quality product images, detailed descriptions, specifications, customer reviews, related products, “Add to Cart” and “Add to Wishlist” buttons.

About Us	Company history, mission and vision statements, team members, awards and recognition, brand values
Gifting	Curated gift collections(wedding, housewarming, birthday), gift registry feature, personalised gift recommendations.
Contact Us	Contact form, store locations with interactive map, phone numbers, email addresses, FAQ section.

Functionality needed:

Advanced Search: Search by product name, brand, category or keyword.

User Accounts: Ability for users to create their own account in order to save addresses, view order history and manage wish lists.

Secure Checkout: Various options for payment such as credit card, EFT, Pay Pal, Buy Now Pay Later and etc.

Product Reviews and Ratings: Customers able to leave products reviews and rank products.

Stock Availability: Instant updates of stock availability "In stock" or "Out of stock".

Promotional Bans and Discount Codes: Enable display promotional bans and promotional codes.

Budget

Item	Cost(ZAR)
Domain Registration	R150-R300
Web Hosting(Monthly)	R500-R1500
SSL Certificate(Annual)	Free-R500
Development(One-time)	R10000-R50000
Maintence(Monthly)	R1000-R3000
Marketing(Intial)	R5000-R10000
Total Estimated Budget	R20000-R65000

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